VIRTUAL EMBRYO CHALLENGE

P3 SURVIVAL GUIDE

20 October 2026: validation answers become training data; hidden test boards become the ranking target.

THE ONE-SENTENCE CHANGE

In P2 you tune against hidden validation scores. In P3 those validation answers are released for retraining, while test ground truth stays hidden and each board gives you only two official shots.

1. **Retrain**
   validation ground truth joins your usable training information

2. **Predict**
   generate final hidden-test predictions without biological feedback

3. **Freeze**
   hash + lock the exact artifact you intend to upload

4. **Submit**
   up to 2 official submissions per board for the whole phase

DATES

20 Oct P3 opens **2 Dec final submissions due** **4 Dec evaluation starts**
11 Dec winners announced at NeurIPS

Community visual resource - MIT

P3 SURVIVAL GUIDE

What becomes usable - and what stays hidden

The final phase changes the legal information boundary.

T1

RELEASED AT P3

E10.5 validation released

STILL HIDDEN

E12.5 test stays hidden

T2 heart

RELEASED AT P3

E8.5 + E10.5 validation released

STILL HIDDEN

E12.5 extrap test stays hidden

T2 embryo

RELEASED AT P3

E7.5 validation released

STILL HIDDEN

E7.75 interp test stays hidden

T3

RELEASED AT P3

Gata4 KO validation released

STILL HIDDEN

beta-catenin KO E8.75 stays hidden

RULE OF THUMB

Released validation answers can improve final retraining. Hidden test answers are never distributed. External data still has to respect the held-out-stage/genotype rules and be disclosed.

Community visual resource - MIT

P3 SURVIVAL GUIDE

The scarce-resource checklist

P3 is not the time to discover that you uploaded the wrong artifact.

Format check

Unlimited. Use it aggressively before any official attempt.

Official submissions

2 per board for the whole phase - not per day.

Withdrawal

Official submissions cannot be withdrawn after they are made.

Ranking

The board keeps your best result; the second shot helps or does not.

File cap

A single prediction file may not exceed 1200 MB.

Agent teams

Evidence requirements still apply before scoring.

Community visual resource - MIT

P3 SURVIVAL GUIDE

Final workflow: from retraining to upload

A

Lock training inputs

Record released validation data + every external source.

B

Retrain once, compare internally

Use historical/pseudo splits; do not pretend local targets reveal test rank.

C

Choose candidate

Use uncertainty/stability and biological diagnostics, not one lucky score.

D

Freeze exact artifact

Hash it. Make it read-only. Keep board + slot identity beside it.

E

Run format check

Require PASS on the exact frozen file.

F

Official upload

Double-check board and artifact hash before spending one of two attempts.

Before clicking "official submit"

RIGHT BOARD - RIGHT FILE - RIGHT HASH - FORMAT PASS

Community visual resource - MIT